NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

REVISION HUB
SCAN TO LAUNCH

YEAR 7 ENQUIRY CONQUEST, FEUDALISM, CHURCH VS CROWN, PLAGUE & DYNASTIC CIVIL WAR

MEDIEVAL ENGLAND & THE STRUGGLE FOR POWER (1066–1485)

Overarching Enquiry: "How was power won, maintained, contested, and transformed in Medieval England (1066–1485)?"



PRIMARY OIL PLATE • FRANK WILKIN (1820)

BATTLE ABBEY • EAST SUSSEX • ENGLISH HERITAGE

'The Battle of Hastings: Duke William Invades England'

Monumental historic depiction of Duke William of Normandy leading his heavy cavalry and archers against King Harold II's Anglo-Saxon shield wall on Senlac Hill, 14 October 1066.

THE 8 HISTORICAL ENQUIRIES ACROSS THIS UNIT • KNOWLEDGE CHECKLIST

1066–1485

ENQUIRY 1
Why did William win at Hastings in 1066?
- Death of Edward the Confessor & 1066 succession crisis
- Stamford Bridge victory & Harold's 200-mile forced march south
- Senlac Hill tactics: housecarl shield wall vs Norman feigned retreat

ENQUIRY 2
How did William subjugate and control England?
- Over 500 timber motte-and-bailey castles built to suppress Saxons
- 1069–1070 Harrying of the North: scorched earth & 100,000 dead
- 1086 Domesday Book: complete national fiscal and military survey

ENQUIRY 3
Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?
- Royal common law vs Church canon courts: criminous clerks
- 1164 Constitutions of Clarendon & Becket's resistance and exile
- 1170 cathedral assassination & Henry II's 1174 public whipping penance

ENQUIRY 4
Magna Carta: Liberty or baronial power grab?
- King John's extortionate scutage taxes & loss of Normandy (1214)
- 1215 Runnymede charter: Clause 12, Clause 39 & Clause 61
- Pope Innocent III's annulment & the legacy of the Rule of Law

ENQUIRY 5
What was life like in a medieval village?
- The Three Estates: those who fight, those who pray, those who work
- Manorial system: demesne land, week-work, heriot, and the church tithe
- Parish Doom frescoes: weighing of souls & the terror of the Hellmouth

ENQUIRY 6
How did the Black Death transform society?
- June 1348 arrival of Black Death at Melcombe Regis (bubonic vs pneumonic)
- 30% to 50% mortality: social collapse, mass pits & religious confusion
- Acute labour shortage, peasant wage bargaining & 1351 Statute of Labourers

ENQUIRY 7
Why did the peasants revolt in 1381?
- 1380 Third Poll Tax & John Ball's radical egalitarian preaching
- Rebels storm London, burn Savoy Palace & execute Archbishop Sudbury
- Smithfield confrontation: death of Wat Tyler & Richard II's retribution

ENQUIRY 8
Why did the nobility tear England apart?
- Henry VI's mental illness & Bastard Feudalism: private noble armies
- 1461 Battle of Towton: the bloodiest slaughter on English soil
- 1485 Battle of Bosworth: death of Richard III & the Tudor settlement

HOW TO WRITE LIKE A HISTORIAN — 4 GOLDEN RULES & CONNECTIVES

THE 4 GOLDEN RULES OF EXTENDED WRITING:

1. Direct Thesis: Clear answer in sentence 1.

2. Specific Evidence: Names, dates, acts & data.

3. Causal Mechanics: Explain *why* & *how*.

4. Evaluative Balance: Weighted judgement.

HIGH-IMPACT ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

Causation: *Consequently • Precipitated by • Directly resulted in*

Nuance & Evaluation: *Conversely • While ostensibly... in reality • Decisively*

THE 4 BIG STORYLINES TO TRACK — CORE HISTORICAL THEMES

1. Monarchy, Law & State Power: Norman conquest autocracy → Royal justice & Clarendon → Magna Carta & Dynastic collapse (L1–L4, L8)

2. Feudal Economy & Military Tech: Motte-and-bailey engineering → Domesday land audit → Post-plague market economy (L1, L2, L5, L6)

3. Catholic Hegemony & Ideology: Papal supremacy & Becket martyrdom → Doom paintings & tithes → Divine plague etiology (L3, L5, L6)

4. Popular & Baronial Resistance: Saxon rebellions & Hereward → Runnymede baronial revolt → 1381 Peasants' March on London (L2, L4, L7)

LIVING UNIT TIMELINE • PART 1: NORMAN CONQUEST, CASTLES & ROYAL AUTHORITY (1066–1215)

PAGES 2–3
FACING SPREAD

Timeline Mission: In each lesson, turn back to this double-page spread to illustrate the milestone sketchpad with your visual symbol and key notes.

Chronological Spine • Facing Left

1066 **Milestone 1: 1066 & The Battle of Hastings**

14 October 1066 • Housecarls & Shield Wall | Lesson 1

Following the death of Edward the Confessor, Duke William of Normandy defeats King Harold II on Senlac Hill. The Norman cavalry and feigned retreat shatter the Anglo-Saxon shield wall, bringing nine centuries of Anglo-Saxon rule to a violent end.

1069–1086 **Milestone 2: Castles, Harrying of the North & Domesday Survey**

1069–1086 • Motte & Domesday Audit | Lesson 2

William crushes Anglo-Saxon resistance through the brutal Harrying of the North and the rapid construction of over 500 timber motte-and-bailey castles. In 1086, he consolidates control with the Domesday Book, an unprecedented national land and tax audit.

1170 **Milestone 3: Martyrdom of Archbishop Thomas Becket**

29 December 1170 • Benefit of Clergy | Lesson 3

A bitter collision between King Henry II and his former friend Archbishop Thomas Becket over Church courts and criminous clerks culminates in Becket's brutal assassination by four Norman knights in Canterbury Cathedral, forcing the Crown into humiliating public penance.

1215 **Milestone 4: The Signing of Magna Carta at Runnymede**

15 June 1215 • Rule of Law & Due Process | Lesson 4

Rebellious barons force King John to grant Magna Carta at Runnymede meadow near Windsor. Clause 39 guarantees that no free man can be imprisoned without lawful trial by his peers, establishing the revolutionary principle that the Crown is bound by the Rule of Law.

Timeline Check: Why was William of Normandy able to maintain power over two million Anglo-Saxons using castles and the Domesday Book?

See Milestone 5 Facing Right →

LIVING UNIT TIMELINE • PART 2: VILLAGE LIFE, PESTILENCE, REBELLION & CIVIL WAR (1250–1485)

PAGES 2–3
FACING SPREAD

Timeline Mission: In each lesson, turn back to this double-page spread to illustrate the milestone sketchpad with your visual symbol and key notes.

Chronological Spine • Facing Right

c.1250–1330 **Milestone 5: Open-Field Village, Tithes & Doom Paintings**
13th–14th Century • Manorialism & The Tithe | Lesson 5

Medieval peasant life is shaped by the open-field manorial system, week-work on the lord's demesne, and the parish tithe. The Catholic Church exercises profound psychological control through terrifying parish Doom wall paintings depicting the flaming Hellmouth.

1348–1350 **Milestone 6: The Black Death & Breakdown of Serfdom**
1348–1350 • Demographic Collapse | Lesson 6

Yersinia pestis arrives at Melcombe Regis, killing roughly half of England's population in 18 months. The resulting acute labour shortage empowers surviving peasants to demand higher wages, shattering the foundations of feudal serfdom despite the 1351 Statute of Labourers.

1381 **Milestone 7: The Peasants' Revolt & The March on London**
June 1381 • Poll Tax & Egalitarianism | Lesson 7

Furious over the regressive Third Poll Tax and wage restrictions, rural commons led by Wat Tyler and radical priest John Ball march on London, sacking the Savoy Palace and storming the Tower. Richard II tricks the rebels at Smithfield, executing leaders but ending the poll tax.

1455–1485 **Milestone 8: The Wars of the Roses & The Battle of Bosworth**
22 August 1485 • Bastard Feudalism & Tudors | Lesson 8

Thirty years of dynastic slaughter between the House of Lancaster and House of York, driven by Henry VI's weakness and bastard feudalism, culminates at Bosworth Field. Richard III is slain, and Henry VII marries Elizabeth of York, founding the Tudor dynasty.

Timeline Check: How did the demographic collapse of the Black Death and the Wars of the Roses destroy the medieval feudal system by 1485?

Turn overleaf for Lesson 1 (Pages 4–5) →

CHANGE & CONTINUITY

Enquiry 1: Why did William of Normandy win the Battle of Hastings in 1066?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Analyse the 1066 succession crisis following the death of King Edward the Confessor.
- Evaluate the key turning points on Senlac Hill: the shield wall, cavalry charges, and the feigned retreat.
- Formulate a sustained historical argument judging whether Norman tactics or Saxon exhaustion decided the battle.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: Which Anglo-Saxon King of Wessex successfully defended England against the Great Heathen Army in the 870s?

Q2: What was the name of the northeastern territory of England governed under Danish/Viking law?

Q3: In which century did Roman legions withdraw from Britannia, leaving it open to Anglo-Saxon settlement?

Q4: What was the council of Anglo-Saxon nobles and bishops that advised the king and elected his successor called?

Q5: Which King of England died on 5 January 1066 without leaving a direct biological heir?

TASK 2: CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Historical Literacy

Distinguish between King Harold's elite, full-time professional bodyguards (**Housecarls**) and the part-time peasant militia called up in emergencies (**Fyrd**). *Hint: Explain who each group was and how their battle experience differed:*

TASK 3: HASTINGS FACTOR MATRIX: NORMAN MILITARY SUPERIORITY VS ANGLO-SAXON VULNERABILITIES

Extract 3 key pieces of factual evidence into each column, then develop your argument below:

NORMAN MILITARY SUPERIORITY & TACTICS	ANGLO-SAXON VULNERABILITIES & BAD LUCK
Point 1:	**Point 1:**
Point 2:	**Point 2:**
Point 3:	**Point 3:**

✍ **Task 3: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether Norman tactical skill or Saxon exhaustion was the primary cause of William's victory:**

Low-Floor Clue: Remember that Harold's men had already fought a bloody battle against Vikings at Stamford Bridge and marched over 200 miles in two weeks before facing fresh Norman cavalry.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does contemporary Norman chronicler William of Poitiers contrast with the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle in explaining why the shield wall collapsed?*

TASK 4: HISTORICAL SKILL: CHANGE & CONTINUITY • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: Why did William of Normandy win the Battle of Hastings in 1066?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. NORMAN TACTICS	2. SAXON EXHAUSTION	3. SUSTAINED VERDICT
Explain how William's combined cavalry and feigned retreats broke the Saxon shield wall.	Analyse the impact of Stamford Bridge, the 200-mile march, and Harold's tactical impatience.	Reach a reasoned conclusion: was victory decided by military brilliance or battlefield luck?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: William won the Battle of Hastings primarily because... • Most decisively, the Norman tactic of the feigned retreat... • Furthermore, King Harold's Saxon army was critically weakened by... • This exhaustion meant that when the shield wall broke... • On balance, while Harold fought bravely, William's victory was secured by...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific names, dates, acts & data.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 1 on Page 2: Sketch the Norman cavalry charge, the Anglo-Saxon shield wall, or King Harold struck by an arrow.*

Pages 2–3 →

Enquiry 2: How useful are Sources A and B for investigating how William the Conqueror subjugated and controlled England (1066–1086)?

DUAL-SOURCE UTILITY

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Examine the strategic function of motte-and-bailey castles in dominating hostile Anglo-Saxon shires.
- Analyse the brutality of the Harrying of the North and the administrative power of the Domesday Book.
- Evaluate the utility and reliability of monastic chronicles versus bureaucratic fiscal audits.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: On what date was the Battle of Hastings fought in 1066?	**Q2:** What battlefield tactic did Norman cavalry execute to trick the Saxon shield wall into breaking?	**Q3:** What was the term for the elite, mail-clad professional bodyguards who fought around King Harold?	**Q4:** What battle in Yorkshire did Harold Godwinson win on 25 September 1066 before marching south?	**Q5:** Which Norman Duke claimed Edward the Confessor had promised him the English throne in 1051?

TASK 2: CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Historical Literacy

Complete the sentences using: **Motte-and-bailey** (timber castle on a mound), **Castellan** (Norman castle commander), **Harrying of the North** (brutal scorched-earth campaign), **Domesday Book** (1086 national land audit), **Subjugation** (bringing under complete royal control).

To enforce the **(1)** _____ of two million hostile Anglo-Saxons, William ordered the rapid construction of over 500 **(2)** _____ castles garrisoned by a loyal Norman **(3)** _____. Following widespread northern rebellions, William carried out the brutal **(4)** _____ of 1069–70. In 1086, he consolidated fiscal and military control by commissioning the **(5)** _____ to survey every acre of English land.

TASK 3: NORMAN WEAPONS OF CONTROL: PHYSICAL TERROR VS BUREAUCRATIC SURVEILLANCE

Extract 3 key pieces of factual evidence into each column, then develop your argument below:

PHYSICAL TERROR & FORTIFICATIONS (CASTLES & HARRYING)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

BUREAUCRATIC SURVEILLANCE & LAW (DOMESDAY & FEUDALISM)

Point 1:

Point 2:

Point 3:

✍ **Task 3: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether military terror or bureaucratic surveillance was more effective in keeping England under Norman control:**

Low-Floor Clue: Castles and terror crushed immediate rebellions, but Domesday and the feudal system ensured William could tax and govern England permanently.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *Why did 19th-century historians view the Domesday Book as administrative genius, while contemporary Saxons viewed it as an intrusive instrument of conquest?*

TASK 4: HISTORICAL SKILL: DUAL-SOURCE UTILITY • DUAL-SOURCE EVIDENCE

Enquiry: How useful are Sources A and B for investigating how William the Conqueror subjugated and controlled England (1066–1086)?

EDEXCEL PAPER 1 & 3 PREP

SOURCE A: ORDERIC VITALIS, ECCLESIASTICAL HISTORY (C. 1120S)

"King William vented his fury by commanding that all crops, herds, and food of every kind should be burned to ashes. More than 100,000 human beings perished of hunger in Yorkshire alone. I have often praised William in this book, but for this savage slaughter I can only weep and condemn him."

Record: BIBLIOTHÈQUE NATIONALE DE FRANCE • PARIS • MS LATIN 5506

Provenance Clue: Written by an Anglo-Norman monk whose father served William; unusually critical of royal cruelty, reflecting genuine horror at the human cost of the Harrying.

SOURCE B: THE GREAT DOMESDAY BOOK: HUNDRED OF FAREHAM (1086)

"In Fareham, King William holds the manor. In the time of King Edward, it was assessed at 30 hides. There is land for 30 ploughs. In demesne are 4 ploughs; and 30 villeins and 15 smallholders with 18 ploughs. There are 2 mills, 3 fisheries, and woodland for 20 pigs. Its total value was £40; now £30."

Record: THE NATIONAL ARCHIVES • KEW • E 31/2/2 (DOMESDAY FOLIO 44)

Provenance Clue: Verbatim entry from William's royal tax audit; an objective, cold bureaucratic record detailing land ownership, peasant labour, and taxable wealth in Hampshire.

1. CONTENT & DETAIL

Analyse what each source reveals about William's methods (military terror and famine vs bureaucratic surveillance).

2. PROVENANCE & MOTIVE

Evaluate how authorship affects utility: a repentant monastic chronicle vs an official royal fiscal audit.

3. HISTORICAL JUDGEMENT

Reach a reasoned verdict: which source is more useful for understanding how Normans maintained control?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Source A is valuable for revealing the extreme physical terror William used to crush... • However, its utility is shaped by the author's moral outrage as a Christian monk... • In contrast, Source B provides precise, forensic evidence of Norman bureaucratic control through... • When cross-referenced, both sources prove that Norman power rested on... • On balance, Source [A/B] is more useful because...

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Source Utility: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Provenance: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **Judgement:** [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 2 on Page 2: Sketch a timber motte-and-bailey castle, Portchester Castle keep, or the Domesday Book.*

Pages 2–3 →

CAUSATION & TRANSFORMATION

Enquiry 3: Why did the dispute between King Henry II and Thomas Becket escalate into cathedral murder (1162–1170)?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Understand the clash between royal common law and Church canon law over criminous clerks.
- Explain how Henry II's friendship with Becket transformed into bitter institutional enmity.
- Evaluate why the four knights assassinated Becket and how Henry II was forced into public humiliation.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: What were the two main parts of an early Norman timber castle?	Q2: What brutal scorched-earth campaign did William I carry out across Yorkshire in the winter of 1069–1070?	Q3: What unprecedented national survey of land, livestock, and wealth was completed in 1086?	Q4: Which Hampshire castle features a Norman stone keep built directly inside Roman fort walls?	Q5: Roughly how many Norman invaders successfully ruled over two million Anglo-Saxons after 1066?

TASK 2: CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Historical Literacy

Write a precise historical sentence connecting two of these terms: **Benefit of Clergy** (trial privilege in Church courts), **Criminous Clerks** (clergy accused of crimes), **Excommunication** (banishment from the Catholic Church). *Sentence starter: "King Henry II clashed with Archbishop Becket over criminous clerks because..."*

TASK 3: THE CROWN VS MITRE COLLISION: ROYAL LEGAL AUTHORITY VS PAPAL CHURCH AUTONOMY

Extract 3 key pieces of factual evidence into each column, then develop your argument below:

KING HENRY II'S ROYAL OBJECTIVES	ARCHBISHOP BECKET'S SPIRITUAL RESISTANCE
Point 1:	**Point 1:**
Point 2:	**Point 2:**
Point 3:	**Point 3:**

✍ **Task 3: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether personal pride or deep religious-legal principle was the primary cause of Becket's murder:**

Low-Floor Clue: Henry II thought appointing his drinking friend Becket as Archbishop would let him control the Church, but Becket believed his supreme duty was to God and the Pope, not the King.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How did Becket's martyrdom at Canterbury permanently weaken royal legal supremacy over the Catholic Church in medieval England?*

TASK 4: HISTORICAL SKILL: CAUSATION & TRANSFORMATION • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: Why did the dispute between King Henry II and Thomas Becket escalate into cathedral murder (1162–1170)?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. LEGAL COLLISION	2. PERSONAL VOLATILITY	3. CATHEDRAL MURDER
Explain the clash over criminous clerks, benefit of clergy, and the Constitutions of Clarendon.	Analyse the breakdown of Henry and Becket's friendship, exile, and the Young King's coronation.	Evaluate the outburst of Henry II, the knights' actions, and the long-term triumph of Becket's martyrdom.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The dispute between Henry II and Thomas Becket escalated primarily because... • At the heart of the crisis was the controversial issue of... • Crucially, when Henry issued the Constitutions of Clarendon, Becket... • This personal and constitutional friction exploded when Becket excommunicated... • Ultimately, while Henry never intended Becket's murder, his fatal outburst directly caused...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific names, dates, acts & data.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 3 on Page 2: Sketch the Archbishop's cross, the four knights in Canterbury Cathedral, or Henry II's public penance.*

Pages 2–3 →

HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE

Enquiry 4: To what extent was Magna Carta (1215) a selfish baronial power grab rather than a foundation of liberty?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Examine King John's financial extortions, loss of Normandy, and clashes with Pope Innocent III.
- Analyse the key clauses of Magna Carta: Clause 12 (taxation), Clause 39 (trial by peers), Clause 61 (security).
- Judge whether the Great Charter was an aristocratic treaty protecting noble wealth or the birth of constitutional monarchy.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: In which cathedral was Archbishop Thomas Becket murdered on 29 December 1170?	**Q2:** What 1164 royal document issued by Henry II attempted to strip Church courts of criminal cases?	**Q3:** What legal privilege allowed educated men to claim trial in lenient Church courts rather than royal courts?	**Q4:** What severe religious penalty did the Pope use to cut a Christian off from the sacraments and Church community?	**Q5:** What public act of penance did King Henry II undergo at Canterbury Cathedral in July 1174?

TASK 2: CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Historical Literacy

Distinguish between the medieval feudal tax paid by barons in place of military service (**Scutage**) and the legal principle protecting free subjects from arbitrary imprisonment without trial (**Due Process / Habeas Corpus**). *Hint: Explain what each term meant and why barons demanded due process in 1215:*

TASK 3: MAGNA CARTA BALANCE SHEET: SELFISH BARONIAL SHIELD VS ENDURING CHARTER OF LIBERTY

Extract 3 key pieces of factual evidence into each column, then develop your argument below:

SELFISH BARONIAL SHIELD (13TH-CENTURY REALITY)	ENDURING FOUNDATION OF LIBERTY (LONG-TERM LEGACY)
Point 1:	**Point 1:**
Point 2:	**Point 2:**
Point 3:	**Point 3:**

✍ **Task 3: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether Magna Carta was primarily a selfish baronial treaty or a genuine turning point for human rights:**

Low-Floor Clue: In 1215, Magna Carta only protected the rights of "free men"—meaning wealthy nobles and churchmen—leaving millions of unfree peasants completely unprotected.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does historian J.C. Holt challenge Victorian myths of Magna Carta as an ancient democratic constitution?*

TASK 4: HISTORICAL SKILL: HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: To what extent was Magna Carta (1215) a selfish baronial power grab rather than a foundation of liberty?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. BARONIAL GRIEVANCES	2. 1215 REALITY	3. LONG-TERM SIGNIFICANCE
Explain King John's military defeats in Normandy, heavy scutage taxation, and feudal abuse.	Analyse how the charter protected noble privileges and ignored the vast majority of peasants.	Evaluate how Clause 39 established the principle that even monarchs are bound by the Rule of Law.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: In June 1215, King John was forced to agree to Magna Carta because... • On the one hand, historians argue the charter was a selfish power grab because... • Crucially, the document explicitly ignored the rights of... • However, its enduring historical significance lies in Clause 39, which established that... • On balance, while born of noble greed, Magna Carta became revolutionary because...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry. **[E] Evidence:** Specific names, dates, acts & data. **[E] Explanation:** Causal mechanism (why & how). **[L] Link:** Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 4 on Page 2: Sketch King John with the Great Seal, the rebellious barons at Runnymede, or Clause 39 parchment.*

Pages 2–3 →

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL DEBATE

Enquiry 5: Were medieval peasants helpless victims of feudal oppression, or active community negotiators?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Examine the social structure of the Three Estates (*bellatores*, *oratores*, *laboratores*) and the open-field manor.
- Analyse the oppressive feudal dues (week-work, heriot, merchet, tithe) enforced by lords and the Church.
- Evaluate how Doom paintings controlled peasant minds and how peasants negotiated customary rights in manorial courts.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: On which meadow near Windsor did King John meet his rebellious barons in June 1215?	**Q2:** What tax did King John extort 11 times from his barons to pay for failed wars in Normandy?	**Q3:** Which famous clause in Magna Carta guaranteed that no free man could be imprisoned without lawful trial?	**Q4:** Which Pope issued a papal bull declaring Magna Carta null and void in August 1215?	**Q5:** Which King was murdered in Canterbury Cathedral in 1170 after clashing with his former chancellor?

TASK 2: CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Historical Literacy

Complete the sentences using: **Villein** (unfree peasant bound to land), **Tithe** (one-tenth harvest tax paid to the Church), **Demesne** (the lord's personal home farm), **Hellmouth** (monstrous mouth swallowing sinners into Hell), **Manorialism** (the medieval village farming system).

Under the economic system of **(1)** _____, an unfree peasant known as a **(2)** _____ was legally tied to the land. Peasants farmed their own strips while performing unpaid labour on the lord's personal estate, called the **(3)** _____. In addition, villagers gave one-tenth of their harvest as a **(4)** _____ to the Church, terrified by wall paintings depicting the fiery **(5)** _____ awaiting sinners.

TASK 3: THE PEASANT AGENCY AUDIT: FEUDAL OPPRESSION VS COMMUNAL NEGOTIATION

Extract 3 key pieces of factual evidence into each column, then develop your argument below:

FEUDAL OPPRESSION & SPIRITUAL TERROR (HELPLESS VICTIMS)	COMMUNAL RESILIENCE & AGENCY (ACTIVE NEGOTIATORS)
Point 1:	**Point 1:**
Point 2:	**Point 2:**
Point 3:	**Point 3:**

✍ **Task 3: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether fear of Hell and the lord's power made medieval peasant life miserable or whether community solidarity gave them agency:**

Low-Floor Clue: While lords held legal ownership of the land, they relied completely on peasants to plow, plant, and harvest; if peasants banded together, lords were often forced to compromise.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How does modern micro-history (e.g. Christopher Dyer's analysis of manorial rolls) dismantle the Victorian myth of the groveling, miserable medieval serf?*

TASK 4: HISTORICAL SKILL: HISTORIOGRAPHICAL DEBATE • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: Were medieval peasants helpless victims of feudal oppression, or active community negotiators?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. FEUDAL CONTROL	2. SPIRITUAL FEAR	3. PEASANT AGENCY
Explain the physical, legal, and financial burdens of manorialism (demesne, week-work, heriot).	Analyse the psychological impact of church Doom paintings, tithes, and eternal damnation.	Evaluate how village cooperation, open-field routines, and court records prove communal resilience.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Medieval village life was heavily structured by the feudal system because... • On the surface, peasants appeared powerless under burdensome dues like... • Furthermore, the parish church reinforced submission by displaying terrifying Doom paintings of... • However, revisionist social historians demonstrate that villagers... • In conclusion, while feudalism imposed harsh boundaries, ordinary peasants actively...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry. **[E] Evidence:** Specific names, dates, acts & data. **[E] Explanation:** Causal mechanism (why & how). **[L] Link:** Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 5 on Page 3: Sketch an open-field strip farm, a church Doom painting with the Hellmouth, or a peasant harvesting wheat.*

Pages 2–3 →

TURNING POINT ANALYSIS

Enquiry 6: How significantly did the Black Death of 1348 transform English society and shatter the feudal system?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Trace the arrival of *Yersinia pestis* at Melcombe Regis in 1348 and distinguish bubonic from pneumonic symptoms.
- Analyse contemporary explanations: divine punishment, corrupt air (miasma), and planetary alignments.
- Evaluate the economic revolution: acute labour scarcity, peasant wage-bargaining, and the 1351 Statute of Labourers.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: What proportion of their annual crop were medieval villagers legally forced to pay to the Church as a tithe?	**Q2:** What was the term for an unfree peasant legally bound to the land and forced to work on the lord's demesne?	**Q3:** What terrifying church wall painting depicted Christ judging humanity and demons dragging sinners into Hell?	**Q4:** What agricultural system used three large communal fields rotated annually to preserve soil fertility?	**Q5:** Which grand bishop's palace in Hampshire was built by the wealthy Bishop of Winchester in the 12th century?

TASK 2: CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Historical Literacy

Distinguish between the flea-borne strain of the Black Death causing agonising swellings in lymph nodes (**Bubonic Plague**) and the airborne, highly contagious lung infection that was 100% fatal (**Pneumonic Plague**). *Hint: Explain how each strain was caught and why pneumonic plague was far deadlier:*

TASK 3: THE DEMOGRAPHIC COLLAPSE BALANCE SHEET: SHORT-TERM HORROR VS LONG-TERM PEASANT LIBERATION

Extract 3 key pieces of factual evidence into each column, then develop your argument below:

SHORT-TERM HORROR & CHAOS (1348–1350)	LONG-TERM SOCIOECONOMIC REVOLUTION (1350–1400)
Point 1:	**Point 1:**
Point 2:	**Point 2:**
Point 3:	**Point 3:**

✍ **Task 3: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether the Black Death was primarily an unmitigated human catastrophe or an engine of social progress for the working poor:**

Low-Floor Clue: With half the workers dead, landlords had to compete for surviving peasants; if a lord refused to pay high wages or free a serf, the peasant simply moved to another village.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How did economic historian Michael Postan interpret the Black Death as a classic Malthusian demographic correction rather than an unpredictable bolt from the blue?*

TASK 4: HISTORICAL SKILL: TURNING POINT ANALYSIS • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: How significantly did the Black Death of 1348 transform English society and shatter the feudal system?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. CATASTROPHIC IMPACT

Explain the horrific mortality (30–50%), symptoms, mass burial pits, and religious confusion.

2. ECONOMIC REVOLUTION

Analyse the labour shortage, wage inflation, peasant mobility, and landlord panic.

3. FEUDAL CRACKDOWN

Evaluate the 1351 Statute of Labourers and how it sowed the seeds for the 1381 Peasants' Revolt.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The Black Death of 1348 was a profound historical turning point because... • Initially, the pandemic brought unimaginable catastrophe, killing... • However, the resulting demographic collapse created an acute shortage of... • Consequently, surviving peasants realized their labour was valuable and demanded... • While Parliament attempted to reverse this through the 1351 Statute of Labourers, the Black Death permanently shattered...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry.

[E] Evidence: Specific names, dates, acts & data.

[E] Explanation: Causal mechanism (why & how).

[L] Link: Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 6 on Page 3: Sketch a bubo swelling, a mass plague trench, or peasants demanding higher wages.*

Pages 2–3 →

HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & FORENSIC EXTRACTION

Enquiry 7: How useful are Sources A and B for investigating why the common people rose in rebellion in 1381?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Examine the triggers of the 1381 revolt: the Third Poll Tax, corruption of royal ministers, and John Ball's sermon.
- Analyse the storming of London, the sacking of the Savoy Palace, and the murder of Archbishop Sudbury.
- Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt was an unruly mob riot or a disciplined political revolution for freedom.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: In which year did the Black Death first arrive on English shores at Melcombe Regis?	**Q2:** What bacterial pathogen, carried by rodent fleas, was responsible for the Black Death?	**Q3:** Roughly what proportion of England's population perished during the 1348–1350 epidemic?	**Q4:** What 1351 legislation passed by Parliament attempted to freeze peasant wages at pre-plague rates?	**Q5:** What religious groups whipped their bare backs in public, believing the plague was God's wrath for human sin?

TASK 2: CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Historical Literacy

Write a precise historical sentence connecting two of these terms: **Poll Tax** (equal tax on every person regardless of wealth), **Radical Equality** (belief that all humans are equal in God's eyes), **Charter Revocation** (the King tearing up his promises of freedom). *Sentence starter: "When peasants marched on London to protest the Poll Tax, John Ball preached..."*

TASK 3: THE 1381 REBELLION BALANCE SHEET: ORGANIZED POLITICAL REVOLUTION VS DESTRUCTIVE RIOT

Extract 3 key pieces of factual evidence into each column, then develop your argument below:

ORGANIZED POLITICAL REVOLUTION (DISCIPLINED AIMS)	DESTRUCTIVE ARMED INSURRECTION (VIOLENT EXCESS)
Point 1:	**Point 1:**
Point 2:	**Point 2:**
Point 3:	**Point 3:**

✍ **Task 3: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether the 1381 Peasants' Revolt was an organized movement for human equality or a violent, uncontrolled riot:**

Low-Floor Clue: Notice how the rebels were careful not to steal from the Savoy Palace—they threw gold into the Thames—proving they wanted justice, not common theft.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *Why did King Richard II's famous promise at Mile End—*"I will be your captain"*—mask a ruthless royal counter-offensive that executed hundreds across Essex and Kent?*

TASK 4: HISTORICAL SKILL: HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & FORENSIC EXTRACTION • DUAL-SOURCE EVIDENCE

Enquiry: How useful are Sources A and B for investigating why the common people rose in rebellion in 1381?

EDEXCEL PAPER 1 & 3 PREP

SOURCE A: JEAN FROISSART, CHRONICLES (C. 1380S)

"John Ball, a crack-brained priest of Kent, would gather the people in the cloisters after Mass and preach: 'Good people, matters cannot go well in England until all things are held in common, and there are neither serfs nor gentlemen. How can the lords prove they are greater masters than we? Are we not all descended from Adam and Eve?'"

Record: BRITISH LIBRARY • LONDON • ROYAL MS 18 E.I

Provenance Clue: Chronicler writing for the French-speaking aristocratic elite; hostile to rebels, yet accurately captures the explosive egalitarian theology motivating the peasantry.

SOURCE B: THE ANONIMALLE CHRONICLE: THE EXECUTION ON TOWER HILL (1381)

"The commons dragged Simon Sudbury, Archbishop of Canterbury and Chancellor, out from the chapel in the Tower of London onto Tower Hill. With loud clamour and immense fury, they struck off his head with eight strokes. They placed his head upon London Bridge, along with the royal Treasurer, shouting that they had purged England of corrupt traitors."

Record: LEEDS UNIVERSITY LIBRARY • BROTHERTON COLLECTION • MS 29

Provenance Clue: Detailed eyewitness chronicle written in Anglo-Norman French; records the targeted fury of the commons against corrupt royal tax ministers rather than the boy king.

1. CONTENT & DETAIL

Analyse what each source reveals about rebel motives (egalitarian theology vs fury against corrupt tax collectors).

2. PROVENANCE & MOTIVE

Evaluate how aristocratic fear of peasant rebellion influences the depiction of John Ball and the crowd.

3. HISTORICAL JUDGEMENT

Reach a reasoned conclusion: which source is more useful for understanding why ordinary people rebelled in 1381?

Sentence Starters & Connectives: Source A is valuable for highlighting the ideological and religious motivation behind the revolt, specifically... • However, Froissart's aristocratic prejudice portrays John Ball as... • In contrast, Source B provides precise forensic evidence of the rebels' political targets, demonstrating that... • When cross-referenced, both sources prove that 1381 was driven by... • On balance, Source [A/B] is more valuable for this enquiry because...

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Source Utility: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Provenance: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **Judgement:** [1 • 2 • 3 • 4]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 7 on Page 3: Sketch John Ball preaching on the green, the burning of the Savoy Palace, or the confrontation at Smithfield.*

Pages 2–3 →

AGENCY & HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE

Enquiry 8: Why did the English nobility tear England apart in the Wars of the Roses, and how did Bosworth end the medieval era?

CORE LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

- Understand the dynastic feud between the House of Lancaster (Red Rose) and the House of York (White Rose).
- Analyse the structural disease of "Bastard Feudalism" and the slaughter at the Battle of Towton (1461).
- Evaluate how Richard III's usurpation led to Bosworth Field (1485) and the founding of the Tudor dynasty.

TASK 1: 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Score: / 5

Q1: Which regressive tax, levied equally on all adults regardless of wealth, sparked the 1381 rebellion?	**Q2:** Who was the radical hedge-priest who preached "When Adam delved and Eve span, who was then the gentleman?"	**Q3:** Who was the military leader of the Kentish rebels killed at Smithfield by Mayor William Walworth?	**Q4:** Which 14-year-old monarch met the rebels at Mile End and falsely promised to be their leader?	**Q5:** Which Archbishop of Canterbury and Chancellor was dragged from the Tower of London and executed on Tower Hill?

TASK 2: CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Historical Literacy

Complete the sentences using: **Bastard Feudalism** (paying cash for private armies), **Retainer** (paid private soldier wearing a noble's livery), **Usurpation** (seizing the royal throne unlawfully), **Towton** (1461 snowy battle), **Bosworth Field** (1485 decisive battle).

During the 15th century, the system of **(1)** _____ allowed wealthy nobles to pay cash to maintain private armies of liveried **(2)** _____. The dynastic collision peaked in 1461 at the blizzard battle of **(3)** _____, the bloodiest clash on English soil. Following the mysterious disappearance of the Princes in the Tower and the **(4)** _____ of the throne by Richard III, the war ended in 1485 at **(5)** _____, where Henry VII founded the Tudor dynasty.

TASK 3: THE WARS OF THE ROSES FACTOR MATRIX: ROYAL WEAKNESS VS OVERMIGHTY SUBJECTS

Extract 3 key pieces of factual evidence into each column, then develop your argument below:

ROYAL WEAKNESS & INCOMPETENCE (THE CROWN)	OVERMIGHTY SUBJECTS & BASTARD FEUDALISM (THE NOBILITY)
Point 1:	**Point 1:**
Point 2:	**Point 2:**
Point 3:	**Point 3:**

✍️ **Task 3: Developing Your Argument: Explain whether the Wars of the Roses were caused primarily by the tragic weakness of Henry VI or the unchecked greed of overmighty barons:**

Low-Floor Clue: A medieval king had to be a warrior and a strong judge; when King Henry VI lost his mind, ambitious nobles filled the power vacuum with private armies.

★ ***Scholar's Edge:*** *How did Henry VII's marriage to Elizabeth of York and his ferocious banning of private retainers permanently end the medieval era and establish early modern stability?*

TASK 4: HISTORICAL SKILL: AGENCY & HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE • EXTENDED WRITING

Enquiry: Why did the English nobility tear England apart in the Wars of the Roses, and how did Bosworth end the medieval era?

INDEPENDENT ARGUMENT

1. DYNASTIC FEUD	2. SLAUGHTER & TOWTON	3. BOSWORTH & TUDORS
Explain the rivalry of Lancaster and York, Henry VI's illness, and Bastard Feudalism.	Analyse the brutality of the conflict (Towton, Kingmaker, Princes in the Tower).	Evaluate Richard III's defeat at Bosworth Field and how Henry VII united the roses into stability.

Sentence Starters & Connectives: The Wars of the Roses erupted primarily because... • At the core of the collapse was the fatal weakness of King Henry VI, who... • This void was exploited by overmighty nobles using Bastard Feudalism to... • Consequently, thirty years of slaughter culminated at Bosworth Field when... • Ultimately, the victory of Henry VII in 1485 marked the end of the medieval era because...

[P] Point: Clear direct answer to enquiry. **[E] Evidence:** Specific names, dates, acts & data. **[E] Explanation:** Causal mechanism (why & how). **[L] Link:** Evaluative conclusion.

Teacher Assessment: Effort: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5] Knowledge: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] Analysis: [1 • 2 • 3 • 4] **PEEL:** [P] • [E] • [E] • [L]

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3: *Illustrate Milestone 8 on Page 3: Sketch the Red and White Roses, the blizzard at Towton, or Henry Tudor crowned at Bosworth Field.*

Pages 2–3 →

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY • PUPIL ASSESSMENT RECORD

UNIT: MEDIEVAL ENGLAND & THE STRUGGLE FOR POWER (1066–1485)

PUPIL NAME: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TARGET LEVEL:** _____

KS3 PATHWAY	**Emerging (1–2):** Isolated facts; basic descriptive recall.	**Developing (3):** Identifies causes & features with simple explanation.	**Secure (4–5):** Structured PEEL arguments with precise facts.	**Advanced (6–7):** Evaluates competing causes; nuanced explanation.	**Mastery (8–9):** Sustained historical criteria & historiographical verdicts.
EFFORT RUBRIC	**1 • Concern:** Incomplete work.	**2 • Inconsistent:** Needs prompts.	**3 • Satisfactory:** Meets baseline.	**4 • Good:** Thoughtful scholar.	**5 • Exemplary:** Exceptional pride.

#	ENQUIRY TITLE	HISTORICAL SKILL	DO NOW	TASK 4 GRADE	EFFORT	TEACHER FEEDBACK
L1	Battle of Hastings	Change & Continuity	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L2	Castles & Domesday	Dual-Source Utility	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L3	Henry II & Becket	Causation & Transformation	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L4	Magna Carta	Historical Significance	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L5	Village Life & Faith	Historiographical Debate	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L6	The Black Death	Turning Point Analysis	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L7	Peasants' Revolt	Historical Evidence & Forensic Extraction	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
L8	Wars of the Roses	Agency & Historical Significance	[/5]	[ ]	1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5	
UNIT SUMMATIVE OUTCOME			**[/40]**	[ ]	**[1 2 3 4 5]**	**Signed:** _____ • **Date:** ___/___/2026

OVERALL UNIT FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT & ACADEMIC GUIDANCE — KEY STAGE 3 MASTERY

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT SELF-MARKING QUIZZES (8 LESSONS • 160 QUESTIONS) — Instant Recall Practice

L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6	L7	L8
Battle of Hastings	Castles & Domesd...	Henry II & Becket	Magna Carta	Village Life & Faith	The Black Death	Peasants' Revolt	Wars of the Roses
Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz	Scan to Quiz
[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]	[/20]

SUMMER ASSESSMENT REVISION PROTOCOL • 4 EVIDENCE-BASED RETRIEVAL TECHNIQUES — COGNITIVE SCIENCE IN PRACTICE

1. Spaced Flash Quizzing
Scan each QR code weekly. Retest until you score 100% on factual recall before checking your workbook notes.

2. Dual-Coding Timeline Walk
Turn to Pages 2–3. Cover the written text and narrate the historical story aloud using only your sketchpad symbols.

3. 5-Minute Brain Dumps
Pick an enquiry question. Spend 5 uninterrupted minutes writing every name, date, and cause from memory.

4. Causal Connective Drills
Draft 3 PEEL sentences explaining *why* an event happened using: *Consequently... This directly resulted in...*